

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET A — FOUNDATION & CORE CONCEPTS****CHAPTER 05: STATE AND SOCIETY UP TO 1000 CE**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-A-05

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET A - Foundation & Core Concepts):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
3. Each question offers four options: **(A), (B), (C), and (D)**. Select the single best answer.
4. Darken the corresponding circle on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

Q.1 Which of the following is the oldest of the four Vedas, containing 1,028 hymns (suktas) dedicated to various deities such as Agni, Indra, and Soma?

- (A) Rigveda (B) Samaveda
(C) Yajurveda (D) Atharvaveda

Q.2 In the Early Vedic society, the two tribal consultative assemblies that advised the king (Rajan) on governance and war were called:

- (A) Sabha and Samiti (B) Ur and Sabha
(C) Gram Panchayat and Zila Parishad (D) Vidhana and Kula

Q.3 During the 6th century BCE, the Indian subcontinent witnessed the emergence of 16 prominent territorial kingdoms and republics known as:

- (A) Mahajanapadas (B) Janapadas
(C) Sultans (D) Subahs

Q.4 Which Mahajanapada emerged as the most powerful and prosperous kingdom in northern India, helped by fertile alluvial plains, iron ore mines, and elephant reserves?

- (A) Magadha (B) Gandhara
(C) Kamboja (D) Matsya

Q.5 The Vajji confederacy, with its capital at Vaishali, was an example of which non-monarchical republican form of government?

- (A) Gana or Sangha (Oligarchic Republic) (B) Absolute Hereditary Monarchy
(C) Colonial Governorate (D) Military Dictatorship

Q.6 Who founded the Mauryan Empire around 321 BCE by overthrowing the Nanda dynasty with the strategic guidance of Chanakya (Kautilya)?

- (A) Chandragupta Maurya (B) Ashoka the Great
(C) Bimbisara (D) Pushyamitra Shunga

Q.7 The classical treatise on statecraft, political administration, espionage, and economic policy attributed to Kautilya is titled:

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| (A) Arthashastra | (B) Indica |
| (C) Mudrarakshasa | (D) Harshacharita |

Q.8 Who was the Greek ambassador sent by Seleucus Nicator to the court of Chandragupta Maurya at Pataliputra, who wrote the account titled 'Indica'?

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------|
| (A) Megasthenes | (B) Fa-Hien |
| (C) Hiuen Tsang | (D) Al-Biruni |

Q.9 Which major war fought around 261 BCE caused massive bloodshed that led Emperor Ashoka to renounce military conquest in favor of 'Dhammavijaya' (conquest through righteousness)?

- | | |
|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| (A) Kalinga War | (B) Battle of Hydaspes |
| (C) Battle of Pataliputra | (D) Battle of Kurukshetra |

Q.10 The official language and script most commonly used by Emperor Ashoka for his famous rock and pillar edicts across the Indian heartland was:

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Prakrit language written in Brahmi script | (B) Sanskrit language in Devanagari script |
| (C) Greek language in Roman script | (D) Tamil language in Vatteluttu script |

Q.11 The special category of welfare and moral officers appointed by Emperor Ashoka to propagate ethical principles and ensure civic harmony were called:

- | | |
|-----------------------|----------------|
| (A) Dhamma Mahamattas | (B) Samahartas |
| (C) Yuktas | (D) Rajukas |

Q.12 Which Kushana emperor is celebrated for convening the Fourth Buddhist Council in Kashmir and patronizing the arts and trade along the Silk Road?

- | | |
|--------------|--------------------|
| (A) Kanishka | (B) Vima Kadphises |
| (C) Menander | (D) Rudradaman |

Q.13 The Gupta period (c. 320–550 CE) in Indian history is traditionally hailed as a 'Classical Age' primarily because of:

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) Unprecedented achievements in Sanskrit literature, arts, architecture, mathematics, and astronomy | (B) The total abandonment of cities in favor of nomadic wandering |
| (C) The introduction of modern industrial coal mines | (D) The conquest of the European continent |

Q.14 The famous eulogy (Prashasti) detailing the military victories and digvijaya of Gupta emperor Samudragupta on the Allahabad pillar was composed by his court poet:

- | | |
|----------------|---------------|
| (A) Harishena | (B) Kalidasa |
| (C) Banabhatta | (D) Ravikirti |

Q.15 The legendary Gupta mathematician and astronomer who formulated that the Earth is spherical, rotates on its axis, and accurately calculated the solar year was:

- | | |
|-----------------|------------------|
| (A) Aryabhata | (B) Varahamihira |
| (C) Brahmagupta | (D) Charaka |

Q.16 Which Chinese Buddhist pilgrim visited India during the reign of Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya) to collect authentic Buddhist monastic texts?

- | | |
|----------------------|----------------------------|
| (A) Fa-Hien (Faxian) | (B) Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang) |
| (C) I-Tsing (Yijing) | (D) Marco Polo |

Q.17 The Iron Pillar standing near the Qutub Minar in Mehrauli, Delhi, famous for its rust-resistant metallurgy after 1,600 years, bears an inscription referring to a king named:

- | | |
|-------------------------------|--------------|
| (A) Chandra (Chandragupta II) | (B) Ashoka |
| (C) Harshavardhana | (D) Kanishka |

Q.18 King Harshavardhana of Kannauj (ruled 606–647 CE) was described in the biography 'Harshacharita' written by his court poet:

- | | |
|----------------|---------------|
| (A) Banabhatta | (B) Harishena |
| (C) Bhasa | (D) Dandin |

Q.19 Which great international Buddhist monastery and university in Bihar flourished under the patronage of the Guptas, Harsha, and the Palas?

- | | |
|------------------------|-----------------|
| (A) Nalanda Mahavihara | (B) Takshashila |
| (C) Vikramashila | (D) Vallabhi |

Q.20 In ancient South India, the earliest flourishing Tamil literary corpus composed during assemblies of poets in Madurai is known as:

- | | |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| (A) Sangam literature | (B) Bhakti literature |
| (C) Upanishadic texts | (D) Agamas |

Q.21 The Pallava dynasty of Kanchipuram is celebrated for constructing which architectural marvels along the Tamil Nadu coastline?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Shore Temple and monolithic rock-cut Rathas at Mahabalipuram (Mamallapuram) | (B) Brihadisvara Temple at Thanjavur |
| (C) Sun Temple at Konark | (D) Kandariya Mahadeva Temple at Khajuraho |

Q.22 The Chola kingdom was uniquely renowned for its highly organized system of democratic local self-government featuring village assemblies known as the:

- | | |
|------------------------------|------------------------|
| (A) Ur and Sabha (Mahasabha) | (B) Sabha and Samiti |
| (C) Janapada and Gana | (D) Guild and Senapati |

Q.23 The detailed qualifications, election rules by lottery (Kudavolai system), and committee duties of Chola village assemblies are recorded in the famous inscription at:

- | | |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| (A) Uttaramerur (Tamil Nadu) | (B) Aihole (Karnataka) |
| (C) Hathigumpha (Odisha) | (D) Besnagar (Madhya Pradesh) |

Q.24 The grand granite Brihadisvara Temple at Thanjavur, dedicated to Lord Shiva and featuring a massive vimana, was consecrated in 1010 CE by the Chola emperor:

- | | |
|----------------------|----------------------|
| (A) Rajaraja Chola I | (B) Rajendra Chola I |
| (C) Karikala Chola | (D) Kulothunga Chola |

Q.25 The Aihole inscription composed in 634 CE by court poet Ravikirti celebrates the victory of Chalukya King Pulakeshin II over:

- (A) Harshavardhana of Kannauj on the banks of Narmada (B) Chandragupta Maurya
(C) Ashoka (D) Samudragupta

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET A)

01	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	02	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	03	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	04	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	05	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
06	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	07	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	08	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	09	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	10	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	12	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	13	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	14	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	15	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
16	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
21	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET A)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Conceptual Rationale
Q.1	(A)	The Rigveda is the earliest Vedic text, composed around 1500–1000 BCE, consisting of 1,028 hymns organized into 10 Mandalas.
Q.2	(A)	The Sabha (an assembly of village elders/elites) and the Samiti (a broader general folk assembly) checked royal authority in Early Vedic times.
Q.3	(A)	By the 6th century BCE, 16 powerful territorial states called Mahajanapadas (such as Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa, and Avanti) emerged in northern India.
Q.4	(A)	Magadha (modern Bihar) became pre-eminent due to fertile Ganga-Son agricultural tracts, rich iron ore deposits in Rajgir/Chota Nagpur, and timber/elephants.
Q.5	(A)	Vajji was governed as a Gana or Sangha, where power was shared among a council of rajas rather than a single hereditary monarch.
Q.6	(A)	Chandragupta Maurya founded the Mauryan Empire, uniting vast territories of the subcontinent under centralized administration.
Q.7	(A)	Kautilya's Arthashastra is a comprehensive ancient Sanskrit treatise on statecraft, military strategy, fiscal administration, and governance.
Q.8	(A)	Megasthenes was the Seleucid envoy whose book 'Indica' recorded invaluable observations of Mauryan administration, military, and society.
Q.9	(A)	The horrific carnage of the Kalinga War deeply moved Ashoka, leading him to embrace Buddhism and preach Dhamma (moral living and non-violence).
Q.10	(A)	Ashoka's edicts intended for ordinary citizens were composed in Prakrit (the vernacular tongue) and carved in Brahmi script.
Q.11	(A)	Ashoka instituted the office of Dhamma Mahamattas, senior officials dedicated to propagating dharma, charity, and social welfare.
Q.12	(A)	Emperor Kanishka (c. 78–144 CE) was a great patron of Buddhism, presided over the 4th Buddhist Council, and issued exquisite gold coins.
Q.13	(A)	The Gupta era saw remarkable intellectual and cultural flourishing: Kalidasa's poetry, Aryabhata's astronomy, Ajanta cave murals, and temple architecture.
Q.14	(A)	Harishena composed the Allahabad Stone Pillar Inscription (Prayag Prashasti) in refined Sanskrit praising the campaigns of Samudragupta.
Q.15	(A)	Aryabhata, in his landmark work 'Aryabhatiya' (499 CE), expounded the earth's rotation, the nature of solar/lunar eclipses, and trigonometric concepts.
Q.16	(A)	Fa-Hien traveled through northern India during the early 5th century CE, leaving detailed descriptions of peace, prosperity, and charitable hospitals.
Q.17	(A)	The Mehrauli Iron Pillar inscription commemorates King 'Chandra' (identified with Chandragupta II), showcasing phenomenal Gupta-era metallurgical mastery.
Q.18	(A)	Banabhatta wrote 'Harshacharita', the first formal historical biography in Sanskrit celebrating the deeds of King Harshavardhana.
Q.19	(A)	Nalanda was a world-famous center of higher learning attracting thousands of scholar-monks from China, Korea, Tibet, and Central Asia.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Conceptual Rationale
Q.20	(A)	The Sangam literature (Ettuthokai, Pattupattu) represents ancient Tamil poetry composed at royal gatherings in Madurai under Pandya patronage.
Q.21	(A)	The Pallavas (particularly Narasimhavarman I) created the iconic rock-cut rathas and structural Shore Temple at Mahabalipuram.
Q.22	(A)	Under the Cholas, villages enjoyed remarkable autonomy; the 'Ur' was a general village assembly, while the 'Sabha' was an assembly of learned Brahmins.
Q.23	(A)	The Uttaramerur inscription of Chola king Parantaka I (c. 921 CE) gives comprehensive rules for conducting village elections using palm-leaf pots.
Q.24	(A)	Rajaraja Chola I constructed the magnificent Brihadisvara (Big) Temple at Thanjavur, a pinnacle of Dravidian architecture.
Q.25	(A)	Pulakeshin II defeated northern emperor Harsha when the latter attempted to expand south across the Narmada River, as recorded at Aihole.